

the ways their personality impacts their breakfast order and which side of the bed they prefer sleeping on.

These assessments can be great tools, and I have seen them help many people take ownership of themselves, but they're just one part of the equation for orienting ourselves to a lifestyle we want. If we lean on them too heavily, we can overemphasize some aspects of who we are and underemphasize or omit others.

If curiosity is a large tent, personality tests are camping out inside that canvas. They are an excellent resource to utilize, but only a small section of the space. There's much more to explore inside the structure.

We also need to move past the noise of the self-help influencers and advertisements telling us that what we really need to aim at is perfect organization, or productivity, or minimalism, or sustainability, or wealth, or living an overwhelmingly nutritious/happy/thin/smiley/outdoorsy/adventurous life. Even if those adjectives do sound kinda great, we definitely don't need all of it, all the time. And we certainly don't need someone else telling us what we need.

Self-reflection is hard and messy, to the point where we may be tempted to skip it and go straight for the action part. This can include procrastinating. You know, avoiding the actual work by buying something that will help with the work. Like purchasing a self-reflection journal instead of just starting with one you already have. Or buying another self-help book instead of reading the ones already on your bookshelf.

It can be hard to pause and ask yourself if your spending lines up with what truly interests you, or if you've been influenced by what the internet, relationships, or even your horoscope tell you about yourself. Depending on your levels of connection with any one of these factors and how deeply rooted your patterns of behavior are, it can be hard to detangle "what's actually me" from "the fantasized, unrealistic version of me."

The type of curiosity-practicing we're advocating for is one that's kind and woven into our lives. This curiosity encompasses so much, including asking questions about ourselves, others, and the world around us. It also challenges our preconceived notions about any one of these categories. Curiosity re-evaluates and gives room for changing our minds or understanding something differently. It creates the space to decide you want to spend differently in different seasons. It provides permission to view debt differently, change your saving approach, modify your investing, and